Ravenhold

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Ravenhold

About this module

This adventure is designed for a party of three to six characters of 3rd to 4th level, and of a non-evil alignment. The module can be played as a stand-alone narrative and also as the third part of the Kryptgarden saga. It takes place in the Forgotten Realms, in the Dessarin Vale, as described in The Storm King's Thunder and Princes of the Apocalypse. All encounters can easily be modified to fit either a larger or a smaller party.

A middle-aged Doomguide enters Red Larch, followed by his near catatonic son, begging for aid. He pleads whoever can help and asks able bodied heroes to help him save his wife, Yiriala, from a warlock-wight that has a lair in the ruins of Ravenhold, an old dwarven tower in Kryptgarden forest. The tower and the dungeons below it are crawling with undead, making the ruins a very dangerous place. Will the PCs manage to unlock the secrets of Ravenhold and save Yiriala?

This book is meant for the Dungeon Master and refers the Player's Handbook, Dungeon Master's Guide, Monster Manual, Volo's Guide to Monsters, Princes of the Apocalypse and The Storm King's Thunder. Spells and items are described in the Player's Handbook, magic items can be found in Dungeon Master's Guide and stat blocks for monsters and villains are in the Monster Manual, unless otherwise noted.

Adventure background

The adventuring party Banner of the Scales was formed in Shadowdale in the year 1469 DR by a young cleric and a devout follower of Kelemvor, Garmund. He teamed up with Anabel Steelhammer, a dwarven druid, Ceras Dolan, human fighter, Yiriala Greenleaf, a half-elf bard, and Maron Arvelia, a tiefling sorcerer. The group set out from the Dales to fight the undead.

A year later the group encountered a dark and evil half-elf warlock, the Thayan Kirial Del'Frai, for the first time in the city Proskur, in the Heartlands. Unbeknownst to Garmund and the rest of the adventuring party, Yiriala and Kirial are siblings and have the same elven father. After discovering that the warlock was robbing graves, disturbing the dead and collecting their bones for his morbid experiments, the party decided to confront him. They fought through his skeleton minions and finally found where Kirial had made his lair in the hills not far from the city. The warlock however was nowhere to be found, and the only clue they had was a letter from another Thayan in Elturel.

The Banner of the Scales travelled across the Heartlands and reached Elturel as winter's first snow fell. Their investigation in Elturel was fruitless

and after spending the winter in the city the group decided to sail west along the River Chionthar and visit Baldur's gate.

When they reached the Gate, they heard that the undead had been sighted in the Trollbark forest, north of Baldur's Gate. After making a brief stop in the city the party headed out again, eager to fight the evil undead of the forest.

Once the party reached the woods, they discovered that Kirial was there as well, trying to find The Warlock's Crypt, hoping to find some of Larloch's treasure. Kirial had grown in power and commanded the undead to attack and destroy the Banner of the Scales. The party fought the skeletons and zombies Kirial had raised and summoned, and finally reached the evil warlock. After a short battle, where Kirial managed to kill Maron, he teleported away and escaped the party once again.

The Banner of the Scales laid Maron to rest in the hills overlooking the Trollbark forest. The party ventured north to Daggerford where they signed on as caravan guards and after fighting off trolls, ogres and goblins the party reached Waterdeep as winter came from the north. The party spent the winter studying and on guard duty in the city.

As spring came Garmund urged his comrades to follow him north along the Long Road, for he had dreamt that they would find the evil warlock there, a dream he believed Kelemvor sent him. The party reluctantly agreed and followed the cleric north.

Once they reached Amphail they learned that skeletons and zombies had been sighted south of Kryptgarden forest. The party investigated and found that Kirial had claimed an old tower as his lair, the old ruins that once were called Ravenhold. The party fought the warlock and his minions. The battle was hard and Ceras was killed by a powerful lightning bolt. Finally, the party managed to surround Kirial at the top of the tower.

"I will return," Kirial screamed as he realized that his days as the evil commander of the undead in the tower were over, "I will return and ruin everything you hold dear. Everything you love will wither and die before your eyes."

Garmund brought forth a scroll with a very powerful spell and summoned a pillar of flame, that engulfed and killed the warlock, leaving only burned and charred remains.

After the fight the party laid Ceras to rest in a barrow near Red Larch. Yiriala and Garmund travelled north, all the way to Ten Towns before coming back more than a decade later and settling in Triboar village, with Olaf, their son.

Anabel, however, stayed behind and made her home in the fields north of Amphail, where she has helped the farmers and erected her own circle of stones.

Recent developments

A few months ago, the alhoon Val'Xootiz and his retinue of warlocks and warmongers came to Kryptgarden forest through the Underdark and, in the dragon's absence, took over Old Gnawbone's (or Claugiyliamatar) lair in Deeping Cave. Old Gnawbone left early summer to meddle with and watch how the affair with the giants unfolded (see The Storm King's Thunder). She also spent a few weeks in Waterdeep, tending to her own affairs.

Recently the alhoon's evil influence has been tainting the forest and all the inhabitants of the woods have felt its presence. Even the goblins are starving, since game has retreated, and other sylvan creatures have moved southwards. Until now only the inhabitants of the forest have been aware of the changes in the forest (see the first installment of the Kryptgarden Saga, The Lost Tomb of the Dwarven Prince).

Val'Xootiz found the remains of Kirial in Ravenhold and raised him as an advanced Deathlock wight. Kirial has retained some of the magical powers he had in life and although being bound to Val'Xootiz, his thirst for revenge against the Banner of the Scales runs deep.

The alhoon tasked Kirial with enlarging its army of undead and restore Ravenhold. Kirial didn't wait and started attacking adventurers and later caravans from Amphail, as his horde of zombies grew. But once the warlock-wight discovered that Garmund, the cleric who killed him, lived in Triboar with Yiriala, Kirial was consumed with thirst for vengeance. Kirial attacked Garmund late one night and captured Olaf, son of Garmund and Yiriala, provoking Garmund to gather his party once more and attack Ravenhold (see the second installment of the Kryptgarden Saga, Return of the Warlock).

Garmund and Yiriala turned to local heroes and persuaded them to join their quest. The heroes were tasked with finding Anabel and get her to meet Garmund and Yiriala by Caser's mound, while Garmund and Yiriala went to Phandalin to claim some of Kirial's treasure, which the Banner of the Scales had gathered after the fight against the warlock all these years ago.

Once the heroes met Garmund and his wife by the barrow they discovered that the warlock-wight had opened the crypt and raised Caser as zombie lord.

The warlock wight attacked the Doomguide, gravely wounded him and teleported away with Yiriala, leaving Olaf behind. The boy's mind had been shattered an Intellect Devourer, which was left in Ravenhold by Val'Xootiz.

The alhoon has tightened its grip on Kryptgarden forest. The sylvan creatures that lived there have either fled or been killed, game has fled and the goblin tribes that live in the forest have either fallen under the Alhoon's spell or are starving. Val'Xootiz has had three unicorns, all forest masters, captured and syphons their life energy to strengthen its spells and empower its enchantment over the forest, which makes all the creatures in the forest more susceptible to its domination. The enchantment also repels and stops Old Gnawbone from returning to Kryptgarden and she is trying to find a way to thwart and dispel the alhoon's spell.

Adventure overview

Garmund, entering Red Larch wounded and exhausted, asks the PCs for their help. Kirial, a powerful Warlock-Wight, has captured his wife, Yiriala, and holds her captive in Ravenhold. When the PCs find the ruins of Ravenhold they discover that the old dwarven tower stands on the border between the prime material plane and Shadowfell.

Enroute to Ravenhold the PCs meet a female elf ranger, named Lia, who is in fact Old Gnawbone in polymorphed form. Lia tells the PCs that she is searching for a unicorn and asks the PCs to keep their eyes open for the enchanted beast, since it is one of the few unicorns that roam Kryptgarden forest.

By unlocking the secrets of Ravenhold and entering the keep on the borders of the Shadowfell, the PCs confront Kirial and his minions. If they prevail, they can not only safe Yiriala from the warlock-wight who holds her imprisoned in a small temple devoted to Shar, but also discover why darkness has fallen over Kryptgarden Forest as the PCs get a chance to save one of the unicorns the alhoon's minions have captured to syphon their life energy.

Getting the PCs involved

It's late autumn in the Dessarin Vale and the caravans going north are a rare sight. Snow caps the mountain tops and the people of the vale often wake up to snowy grounds, though the snow melts during the day. The PCs are in Red Larch, a small town which stands along the Long Road (see PotA p. 19 for description of Red Larch) and even if the town proper isn't large, the community is since there are many farms and hunters living in the vale surrounding the town.

Three persons enter Red Larch early one morning, a Doomguide called Garmund followed by his son Olaf and a dwarven druid named Anabel. The priest is injured and has recently suffered a terrible wound in his abdomen, after fighting Kirial, the warlock-wight and ruler of Ravenhold. He begs anyone near to help him and Anabel calls for help, gaining much attention from the locals.

If the PCs step in, Anabel and Garmund will tell them what happened, how Kirial attacked them and left with Yiriala. Garmund begs the PCs to help him and retrieve his wife from Ravenhold.

If the PCs wish to speak with Olaf, they soon find out that his mind has been shattered. With a successful **DC 12 Wisdom (Insight)** check the PCs know that the boy's mind is broken and needs more time to heal and nothing short of Greater Restoration can help the boy to heal his Intelligence ability damage.

If the PCs agree to helping Garmund, Anabel and Garmund will give them direction on how to find Ravenhold. The Doomguide, biting through the pain from his wounds, also informs the characters that the Warlock-Wight had laid many enchantments on the keep last time Garmund and his adventuring party faced down the warlock, and that they needed to have some of Kirial's equipment to get past his guardians. Anabel hands the PCs a *Robe of Eyes* and *Wand of Paralysis*, both of which were once in the possession of Kirial. Garmund also informs the PCs that when the Banner of the Scales last visited Ravenhold there were many enchantments linked with shadows and darkness.

If the PCs refuse to help, the locals will think little of them and every Charisma check will be made at a disadvantage for the rest of the tenday.

Getting there

Ravenhold stands at the edge of Kryptgarden Forest, about 70 miles north-east from Red Larch. Walking at normal pace the trek should take about three days. The PCs need to find Ravenhold and find the right track towards the old dwarven keep. With a daily successful **DC 12 Wisdom (Survival)** check the PCs manage to follow the directions and move closer to Ravenhold. With a successful **DC 15 Intelligence (Nature)** check the PCs know that the area between Red Larch and Kryptgarden forest is mostly rolling hills and fields, but farms are few and most of them

close to Red Larch.

Roll for encounters as you see fit and suits the playing style of your group. Use the tables for grasslands in Storm King's Thunder p. 68 or Dungeon Master's Guide p. 302.

Meeting Lia

Lia, which is in fact the ancient green dragon Old Gnawbone, is roaming the countryside near Kryptgarden Forest. Due to a powerful Antipathy spell the dragon can't enter the forest and thus can't reach her lair. Val'Xootiz, the alhoon, uses an evil dark magic to zyphon the life energy of three unicorns (see D6) to empower the enchantment. Lia appears to be a friendly female wood elf ranger. Her hair is the color of autumn leaves and her eyes green. With a successful **DC 20 Wisdom (Insight)** check the PCs get a feeling that there's something more to Lia than meets the eye. Old Gnawbone uses polymorph magic to alter her form and appearances. While enroute to Ravenhold the PCs encounter Lia.

The sun is setting and dusk creeps in. Not far are the dark oaks of Kryptgarden forest and somewhere in the woods is the ancient dwarven stronghold. As you are getting ready to find a place to camp you see where someone lights a fire. A soft breeze brings the smell of roasted meat.

If the PCs approach Lia will greet them and invite them to share her fire. She is also willing to share her meat. While they are around the fire, she will ask the PCs what they are doing so far from the Long Road. If the PCs share their story and tell her that they are going to Ravenhold, Lia will nod her head. She will tell them that she has been there once, but that was many years ago (in fact, it was when Gamling Steelshield still ruled the keep). She doesn't remember much, other than the dungeons below the keep were even larger than the keep itself.

She will tell the PCs that she is looking for a friend of hers, a unicorn that used to live in this part of the forest, but she hasn't seen in a while. Lia is planning on searching the lands south of the forest but kindly asks the PCs to look out for her friend, whom she calls Aileeke.

Lia offers to stand watch and takes last watch. In the morning, if the PCs have been friendly, she bids them farewell and tells them that they can often find her in the The Swinging Sword tavern in Red Larch. The dragon will, of course, keep an eye out for the PCs, interested in seeing what they will find and if she can in any way manipulate things so that they help her reclaiming her lair.

Approaching Ravenhold

Ravenhold is mostly overgrown and hidden within the Kryptgarden forest. It stands on a low hill and is reachable both by the old bridge and by climbing the hill, which is rather steep. With a successful **DC 5 Strength (Athletics)** check the PCs climb the hill. The still-intact bridge is adorned with statues of noble dwarven warriors, holding shields and axes, all intricately carved. With a successful **DC 15 Intelligence (History/Stonecunning)** check the PCs know that these statues are made of the same rock as the bedrock of the Sword Mountains.

If you played through Return of the Warlock

If your group played through the second installment of the Darkness over Kryptgarden adventure path, they are already on their way towards Ravenhold and with directions from Garmund and Anabel. Traveling from Caser's burial mound to the old dwarven keep takes two days.

Ravenhold

Late in The Rotting - Year of the Scarlet Witch

Ravenhold is an old dwarven keep since the days of the Besilmer kingdom. It stands at the edge of Kryptgarden forest on a small and lonely cliff, once overlooking the fields and grasslands below. Now the cliff is overgrown and most of the keep is hidden by large firs and pines. The upper levels of the keep appear to be mostly in ruins and to have been deserted for years.

However, the Keep stands where the lines between the Shadowfell and the Prime Material Plane cross and when Selune is full in the night sky, there's more to the keep, as even without powerful plane shifting spells, crossing into the Shadowfell is possible in the keep, should anyone wish to visit that dark and forbidden plane.

Ravenhold's history

Shortly after Thorbin Flametongue founded Besilmer he commissioned to have keeps built at the borders of the kingdom. Little remains today of these keeps, safe for Ravenhold that was for many years thought to be lost as well as the other border keeps.

Gamling Steelshield was made lord of the Kaer Claddu-Coedwig, as Ravenhold was called back then. Gamling was an aging dwarf, one that had many times over proven his worth in battle and was one of Flametongue's most trusted friends.

When Besilmer fell lord Steelshield managed to run the keep for a few decades, but after repeated sieges by orcs, goblins and hogoblins old Steelshield finally gave up and sent the dwarves that lived in the castle south-wards, following in the same footsteps of the other subjects of the Besilmer king. A few decades later Kaer Claddu-Coedwig had been forgotten and the keep fell into disrepair.

Years and ages passed on and the Kryptgarden forest grew ever wilder and slowly the firs and pines of the woods crept in and hid the keep from view. Thus, passed season after season, until the alhoon Val'Xootiz discovered the ruined keep.

For years the dungeon beneath the keep served as the alhoon's lair, which named it Ravenhold for the murder of crows that lived in the main tower. There Val'Xootiz plotted and hatched his plans for taking over the Kryptgarden forest, for the monster coveted the treasures of Old Gnawbone.

When the Thayan Kirial Del'Frai stumbled upon the keep he found it empty, the alhoon had travelled to the Underdark to gather its followers and research how to empower the enchantments the undead later placed on the forest. Kirial had only lived in Ravenhold for a few weeks when Garmund's party stumbled upon him.

After fighting the warlock atop the keep's main tower and defeating him, Banner of the Scales left

Ravenhold, never investigating the dungeon beneath the keep. After the party left, Val'Xootiz found the remains of the warlock, raised Kirial as a warlock-wight and tasked the wight with guarding Ravenhold and do whatever was needed of him to power the enchantments Val'Xootiz has placed on Kryptgarden Forest.

Ravenhold Rules

Bordering the Shadowfell

Ravenhold stands on the border where the Prime Material Plane meets the Shadowfell. In order to access the whole keep the PCs need to perform five rituals. Each ritual gives the PCs access to a certain part of the keep but the final ritual opens a pathway to the deepest and final level of Ravenhold, where Kirial holds Yiriala captive.

The rituals are as follows:

- Lighting all the braziers in R2 and R5 on a night when Selune is full reveals the stairway to the second floor.
- Aligning the columns on second floor in room R13 so that the holy symbols of the evil deities turn inwards reveals the staircase that leads down to D1..
- Filling the cup in in room D3 with fey blood opens the locked door in D1.
- Stepping on the scales and being lighter than a roc feather reveals the hidden passage in D1.
- Attuning to the rune of Kirial on the wall in room D13 gives access to whole Ravenhold.

As each ritual is completed the PCs take one step closer to the Shadowfell. The negative energy grows, and the shadows seem to deepen and get more substantial. This affects both healing magic, fear and the undead. These starts applying the moment the PCs enter the Shadowfell, or once they complete the first ritual.

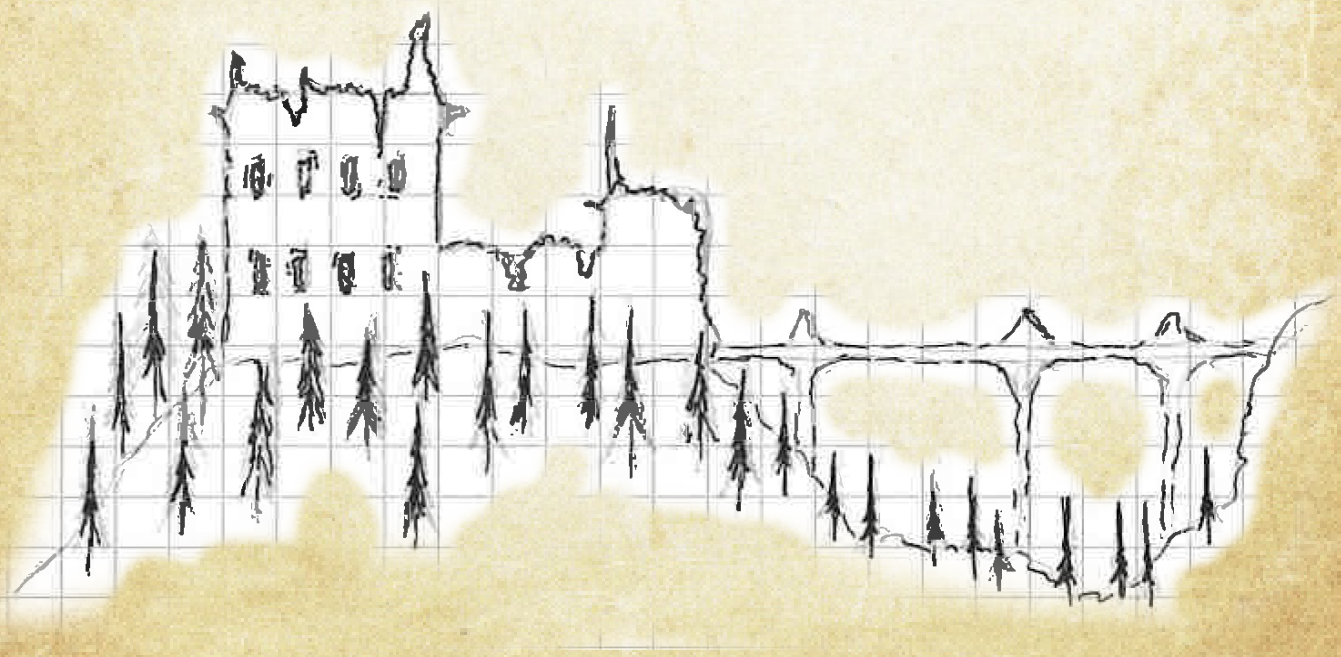
- Spells and abilities that induce fear have a disadvantage to their saving throws.
- Creatures that deliver Negative Energy damage have a +1 to their damage while in Shadowfell. This also applies to abilities, such as Drain Life.
- All creatures in the Shadowfell have a Resistance to healing spells. This also applies to the PCs.
- All light sources are dampened by 50%.
- Any PC that wears the Robe of Eyes and has the Wand of Paralysis will go unnoticed by the undead of Ravenhold.

Ravenhold features

Unless otherwise noted the following are the keep's features. Ravenhold was built by dwarven master stone masons and the corridors are wide and easy to traverse. With a successful **DC 12 Stonecunning check** a dwarven PC quickly spots that the caves were built by dwarves and considerable time and effort was put into building the keep and it was designed to withstand even the hardest sieges.

Floors and walls

The floors and walls are worked and even. All halls are filled with cobwebs and dust.



Doors

All doors are sturdy and made of iron-wrought wood, though the wood itself is decomposed. Unless otherwise noted all doors are locked. The doors can be unlocked with a successful **DC 13 Dexterity check,** using thieves' tools. With a successful **DC 17 Strength (Athletics)** check the doors can be kicked or pried open.

Visibility and light

Unless otherwise noted all halls and rooms are unlit and dark. There are sconces on the walls, but no torches or oil for burning is in the ruined keep nor the dungeon.

Ground floor

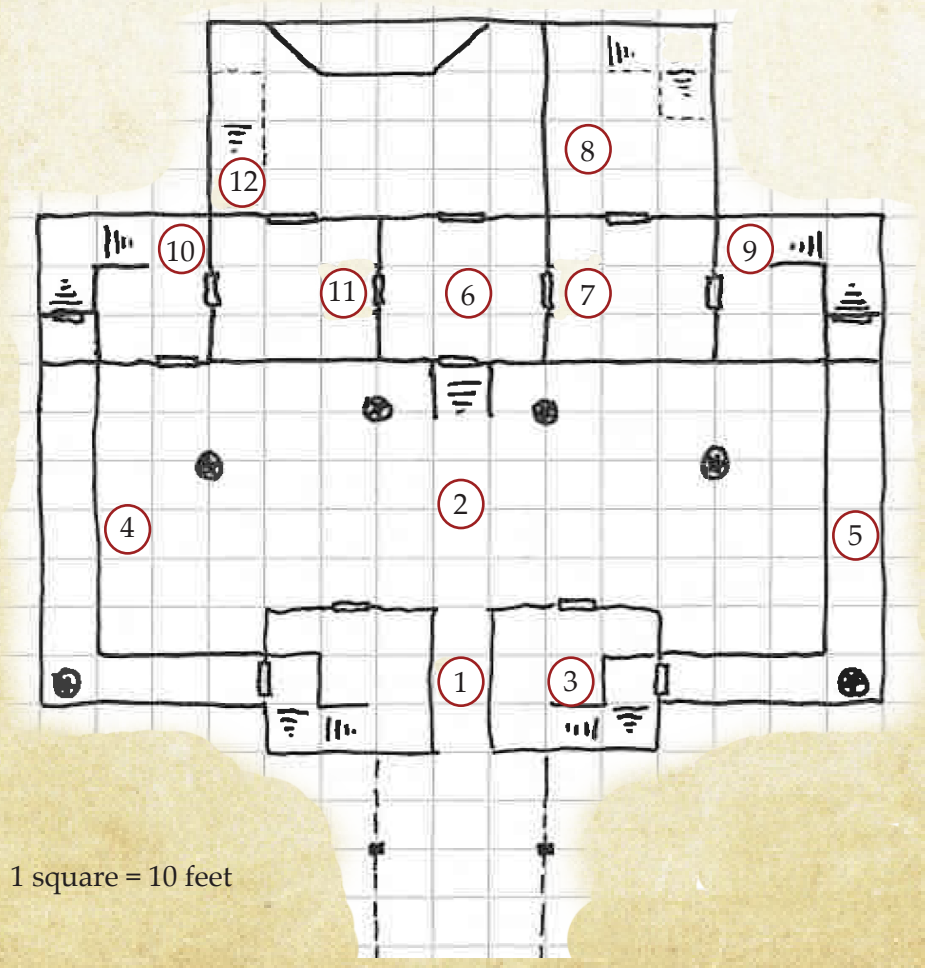
R1. Gate

Ravenhold's gate was once grand, made of thick oak, wrought with ornate iron and copper bindings. The crest of Besilmer adorned the gate, laid in with both silver and gold, both of which has been long ago plied off. In case of an attack the inner gate, which was made of iron, was closed and barred, allowing the dwarven defenders to pour flaming oil on the attackers and let crossbow bolts rain down upon them.

The gate and the gatehouses (see R3 and R4) hold a true testament to dwarven ingenuity and are both built to withstand an attacking army and provide the keep's defenders with the best possible defensive position as possible.

Now the gate is but a ghost of its former glory. The iron bindings are rusty, and the thick oak boards are gray and rotten. The inner gate is also red with rust and the chains that hold it up have long since rusted in place.

As you cross the bridge you can almost feel the stern look of the dwarven statues rest heavily upon you. When you get closer to the gate it is as if the sylvan sounds and the rustle of wind fade away, as if what only remains is the faint memory of the woodland noise. The gate itself was once magnificent, thick oak boards wrought with iron and the intricate crest carved into it. Now it is gray, rotten and the iron rusted. The gate is open and beyond you see dark path, leading into the keep.



1 square = 10 feet

With a successful **DC 13 Intelligence (History)** check the PCs recognize the crest as the royal emblem of Torhild Flametongue, the first king of Besilmer. Torhild was father to Torarinn Flametongue (see The Lost Tomb of the Dwarven Prince, the first installment in Darkness over Kryptgarden). Torhild had Ravenhold built and appointed Gamling Steelshield as lord, but one of the dwarven statues along the bridge depicts Gamling. With a successful **DC 20 Intelligence (History)** check the PCs recognize the statue showing lord Steelshield.

The gate is open. However, once the PCs cross the threshold, they leave the prime material plane and find themselves on the border of the Shadowfell, where gloom and dread prevail, though unbeknownst to them.

R2. Courtyard

The keep's courtyard was large and decorated with statues and shrines devoted to Moradin and Marthammor Duin. The yard is mostly in ruins now, the shrines have been desecrated and destroyed. A large double door, at the end of a flight of stairs, leads into the keep proper and a couple of steep stairs lead to the walls. Four braziers stand in the courtyard, two to each side of the stairs leading to the main door. A pair of giant ravens (see Giant Eagle MM p. 324) have made their nest atop the keep's tower and have their young there. They defend their nest and do their best to steer any intruders away from the keep's courtyard.

Ravenhold's courtyard was once a magnificent place, with the keep and the gatehouse towering over it. Two broken statues once stood on either side of the inner gate, depicting regal dwarves, though they have been defiled and broken. Four brass braziers stand in the middle of the courtyard, two to either side of a wide staircase, leading to a gray wooden double door, framed by large stones with bas-reliefs depicting dwarven warriors. A large black feather lies in the middle of the courtyard. Somewhere a raven calls.

As the PCs enter the courtyard one of the giant ravens takes off from the nest and flies threateningly into the yard. With a successful **DC 13 Wisdom (Insight)** check the PCs feel that the bird means to drive them away. With a successful **DC 14 Charisma (Animal handling)** check the PCs manage to calm the bird down and convince it that they mean no harm to the birds' nest. If the PCs attack the raven the other bird also attacks, both of them fighting to the death defending their young.

If the PCs investigate the statues, with a successful **DC 12 Intelligence (Religion)** check the PCs discover that these were shrines devoted to Moradin and Mathammor Duin. With a successful **DC 15 Intelligence (Investigation)** check the PCs manage to piece together the broken statues.

If the PCs investigate the braziers, they find them surprisingly solid and whole, and there are some coals in them. If the PCs use spells to discern if the braziers are magical, they are and radiate moderately strong conjuration aura. If the PCs light one of the braziers, read or paraphrase the following:

As you bring flames to the coals, they light up very fast, yet the fire emits no heat. The flames are blue and flicker eerily. The shadows seem to deepen all around you.

Three shadows (see MM p. 269) step forth and attack the PCs, once they have the first brazier lit, instructed by Kirial to do so. The shadows fight to the death. If any of the PCs are wearing the Robe of Eyes the shadows will not attack that PC.

The double doors are unlocked, but the doors are on rusty hinges, which makes it hard to open them. With a successful **DC 10 Strength (Athletics)** check the PCs manage to push the door open.

R3. Gatehouse

The gatehouse was used by the gate guards and held assortments of weapons, alarm bells and armor. Now the interior of the house is in ruins and home only to Reginald Ashbiter, a dwarven ghost (see MM p. 147). Reginald was once a guard captain, tasked with organizing the guard duties. Once the PCs enter the gatehouse Reginald starts giving the PCs orders, believing that they are guards of Ravenhold.

Once you open the door to the gatehouse a grim voice calls out: "By Moradin's beard, ye sure took yer time. Now, get yer arses over here and grab yer axes. We is late and need to man the walls." Among the rotten wood, broken chairs and tables you spot a heavily armored dwarf staring at you. His eyebrows are thick, but his beard is cut short. He is holding a shield emblazoned with Flametongue's rune and a two headed battle axe. It's only after a few moments that you realize that you can see through him.

Reginald is not eager to attack, but more willing to

convince the PCs to man positions on the walls, as he was tasked to do all those years ago. He doesn't realize that he is dead and if that is pointed out to him, he dismissed it as rubbish or some kind of a bad joke.

However, the PCs can learn a thing or two from speaking with Reginald. With a successful **DC 14 Charisma (Persuasion)** check the PCs manage to get Reginald to inform them about the keep. Reginald knows that to get to the keep's dungeons the PCs need to make sure that the religious symbols in room R13 are set in the right manner, though he never knew what the right order was. He also knows that Arica had secret compartments made in the dungeon that were part this world, part on some other plane, but that was all magic of some sort.

If the PCs attack Reginald, he will defend himself with all his might, calling out for help and bellowing over and over again that the keep is under an attack. With a successful **DC 12 Wisdom (Insight)** check the ghost seems taken back by the fact that no dwarves come to his aid.

If there's a dwarf with the party Reginald will speak to that PC in dwarven. Though Reginald's accent is ancient with a successful **DC 10 Intelligence** check the PC understand Reginald. If the dwarven PC bears any recognizable dwarven mark or symbol, e.g. holy symbol of the good aligned dwarven gods or even Flametongue (see the Lost Tomb of the Dwarven Prince), Reginald will be more than willing to help. Any Charisma check based made by that PC will be with an advantage.

There's no treasure in the gatehouse, other than 8 rotten crossbow bolts.

R4. Stable

The wooden stable is rotten and in ruins. The roof has fallen in and only a handful of broken poles still stand. A whitened horse skull can be found among the ruins. With a successful **DC 5 Intelligence (Nature)** check the PCs know that this horse has been dead for decades. This was the mount of an adventurer that tried to explore Ravenhold but died trying. If the PCs decide to search in the ruined stable, with a successful **DC 15 Wisdom (Perception)** check they discover four brass horseshoes, laid with magical runes. These are Horseshoes of a Zephyr (see DMG p. 175).

R5. Walls

The keep's walls are 20 feet high and 10 feet thick. On either side of the gatehouse are braziers, which function the same way as the braziers in the courtyard. These need to be lit as well to reveal the staircase to level 2 of the keep. With a successful DC **12 Intelligence (Stonecunning)** check the PCs know that the walls are sturdy and well built.

R6. Main-Entrance

The oaken double doors were once magnificent, displaying the Flametongue rune prominently and wrought with heavy iron bindings. Now, the doors are rotten and gray, mere shadow of their former glory.

The doors are not locked. However, they are very heavy, and the hinges are rusty. Neither Kirial nor his minions use this entrance. With a successful **DC 13 Strength (Athletics)** check the PCs manage to open the door.

With a loud groan the doors finally open. Inside the foyer is like the dark mouth of some hungry beast. Light somehow is dampened and cold. The floor is laid with hexagonal tiles, which lost their color long time ago. The air is stale, heavy with the smell of decay and rot, so heavy that you can almost taste it on your tongue. The keep is silent like a tomb.

The tiles on the floor once depicted the holy symbol of Moradin, though it's hard to determine that now. With a successful **DC 15 Intelligence (Investigation)** check the PCs manage to figure out what symbol was once on the floor. Piles of dust lie along the walls on either side of the double door, which were once rich tapestries, displaying Torhild Flametongue fighting trolls and giants of the High Moor.

R7. Kitchen

The keep's kitchen is large and in a complete disarray. It hasn't been used for decades and there's no treasure there.

This room once served as kitchen. There are pots and pans lying about, and broken plates and cutlery in every corner. The old fireplace hasn't been used for a very long time. A sour stench fills the air.

A pack of 6 giant rats (see MM p. 327) has made their nest here and will defend their area. The rats are provoked by anyone entering the kitchen. With a successful **DC 15 Charisma (Animal Handling)** check the PCs manage to calm the rats. If more than 2 PCs enter the kitchen without trying to calm the rats

the pack attacks. The stench is caused by the vermin and their tendency to leave their feces anyplace near their nest.

R8. Hall

This hall once served as a feasting and dining hall for the dwarves of Ravenhold. A long table, where 10 persons could sit on either side, dominates the room. The Steelshield emblem, a round shield with three stars in the middle, is engraved in the table. On the walls are rusted decorative weapons.

> What used to be a great dining hall is now in ruins. The long table in the middle of the hall is dusty and most of the chairs are broken. There are still some decorative weapons and shields hanging on the walls, though these are rusted beyond repair.

If the PCs investigate the table, they spot the Steelshield insignia, with a successful **DC 18 Intelligence (History)** check the PCs recognize the emblem.

If the PCs have lit the fires in all the braziers in the courtyard, they will see a staircase in the other end of the room.

> In the far end of the hall you see the ghostly outlines of a staircase, leading up to the next floor.

If the PCs climb the stairs, they will end up in R13.

R9. Arsenal

The armory used to hold many hammers, axes and picks, all traditional dwarven weapons. What remains however is mostly rusted and ruined. With a successful **DC 15 Wisdom (Perception)** check the PCs can find a secret compartment behind one of the weapon racks. The compartment is locked, with a successful **DC 12 Dexterity** check and thieves tools the PCs can open it. Inside they find three vials, each is a *Potion of Healing*. Four shadows (see MM p. 269), summoned by Kirial wait in the Arsenal and attack anyone entering it. In one corner are stairs that lead to the walls.

R10. Armory

The armory is in ruins and was looted many years ago. Only a couple of old iron-wrought round oak shields lie in one corner. A few armor-stands stand in the far corner. There are three skeletons (see MM p. 272) that attack mindlessly anyone entering the armory.

R11. Seneschal's office

When Gamling Steelshield ruled Ravenhold, his seneschal was a gruff but fair dwarf woman, Arica Brittlestone, who later became his wife. Arica was a diligent worker, devoted to running the keep and maintaining the small dwarven force posted there. Her office was spartan, only a desk and a few bookcases. Arica, however, died fighting a green dragon, that was Old Gnawbone's mother, that had taken up residence in the Kryptgarden Forest, which almost broke Gamling's heart. He built a beautiful tomb for her, beneath the keep (see room D5).

> A wooden desk dominates this room. The Steelshield emblem is engraved into one side, the Flametongue insignia into the other. A pair of wooden griffons decorate the desk. On the wall behind the desk are bookcases, where you see a few scroll cases and manuscripts.

With a successful **DC 10 Wisdom (Perception)** check the PCs notice a small drawer in the desk. It is locked and trapped with a poison needle, though the poison has since long time ago lost its potency. With a successful **DC 15 Wisdom (Perception)** check the PCs spot the trap and with a **DC 13 Dexterity** check and thieves' tools they manage to disarm it. With a successful **DC 16 Dexterity** check and thieves' tools they manage to unlock the lock and open the drawer. It contains a scroll with the spells *Dispel Magic, Detect Magic* and *Identify*.

The bookcase contains a scroll case with an old map of the routes in Kryptgarden forest, some of which are still in use, while other are more obscure or overgrown. There the PCs can also find a manuscript where they can read up on Flametongue's history (see background and The Lost Tomb of the Dwarven Prince).

R12. Throne room

The throne was once magnificent and beautiful. It contained many dwarven relics and artifacts, art pieces and marble statues. The throne itself was hewn from a solid slab of blue jade and weighs more than a ton. It was laid with gold and copper as well as other gemstones, but the precious metals and gemstones have been taken. The walls were once decorated with tapestries, though most are rotten and are little more than dust on the floor, one is still intact. It shows the Besilmer king battle trolls from the High Moor.

There are 2 wights (see MM p. 300) and 4 shadows (see MM p. 269), all attack anyone entering the throne

room. The shadows try to catch the PCs by surprise and stay hidden in the first round of combat.

The first thing that catches your eyes is the incredible blue jade throne, seemingly made from a single slab of the precious stone. There are broken statues, depicting proud dwarven warriors. Not far from the throne is a beautiful tapestry, showing a dwarven king battling three trolls. There's an unearthly chill in the room, and after a few moments you understand why, as a couple of human warriors step forth, eager to attack. Their skin is white and rotten.

With a successful **DC 12 Intelligence (Religion)** check the PCs recognize their adversaries as wights. With a successful **DC 15 Wisdom (Perception)** check the PCs notice that the shadows in the room seem to move eerily.

If the PCs have solved the riddle in room R13, they will see a translucent stair in one corner of the room, leading down to room D1.

Level 2

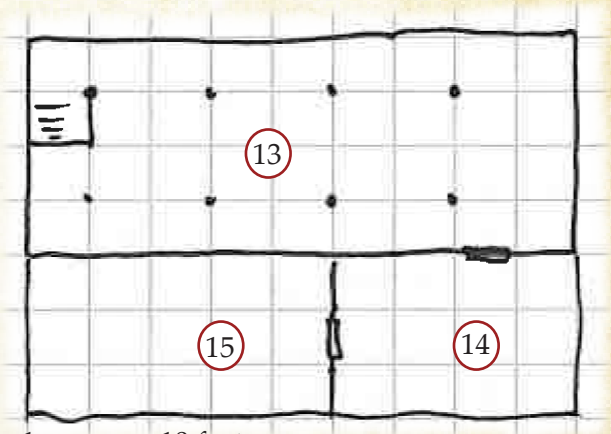
R13. Room of columns

There are eight columns in this room. As a part of each column is a broad steel ring with eight different holy symbols; Bhaal, Bane, Shar, Torm, Myrkul, Malar, Mystra and Waukeen. With a successful **DC 13 Intelligence (Religion)** check the PCs recognize each symbol. With a successful **DC 16 Intelligence (Investigation)** check the PCs see that the brass rings are younger than the columns and must've been added after the keep was abandoned. The rings were installed long before Kirial took over Ravenhold, in fact they were added before the Times of Troubles, but it is not known by whom.

What the PCs need to do to solve this puzzle, in order to be able to enter the dungeon, is to turn each steel ring, so that the evil deities face inwards and the good deities face outwards.

Eight columns dominate this room. Each is smooth and made of marble. A broad brass ring circles each column, eight different holy symbols are engraved in each ring. On the other side of the room is a wooden door.

Once the PCs have solved the riddle the room becomes darker and the shades deeper. From now on the light sources are dampened by 50% as the PCs are now getting closer to the Shadowfell. With a successful **DC 15 Intelligence (Arcana)** check the PCs realize this.



1 square = 10 feet

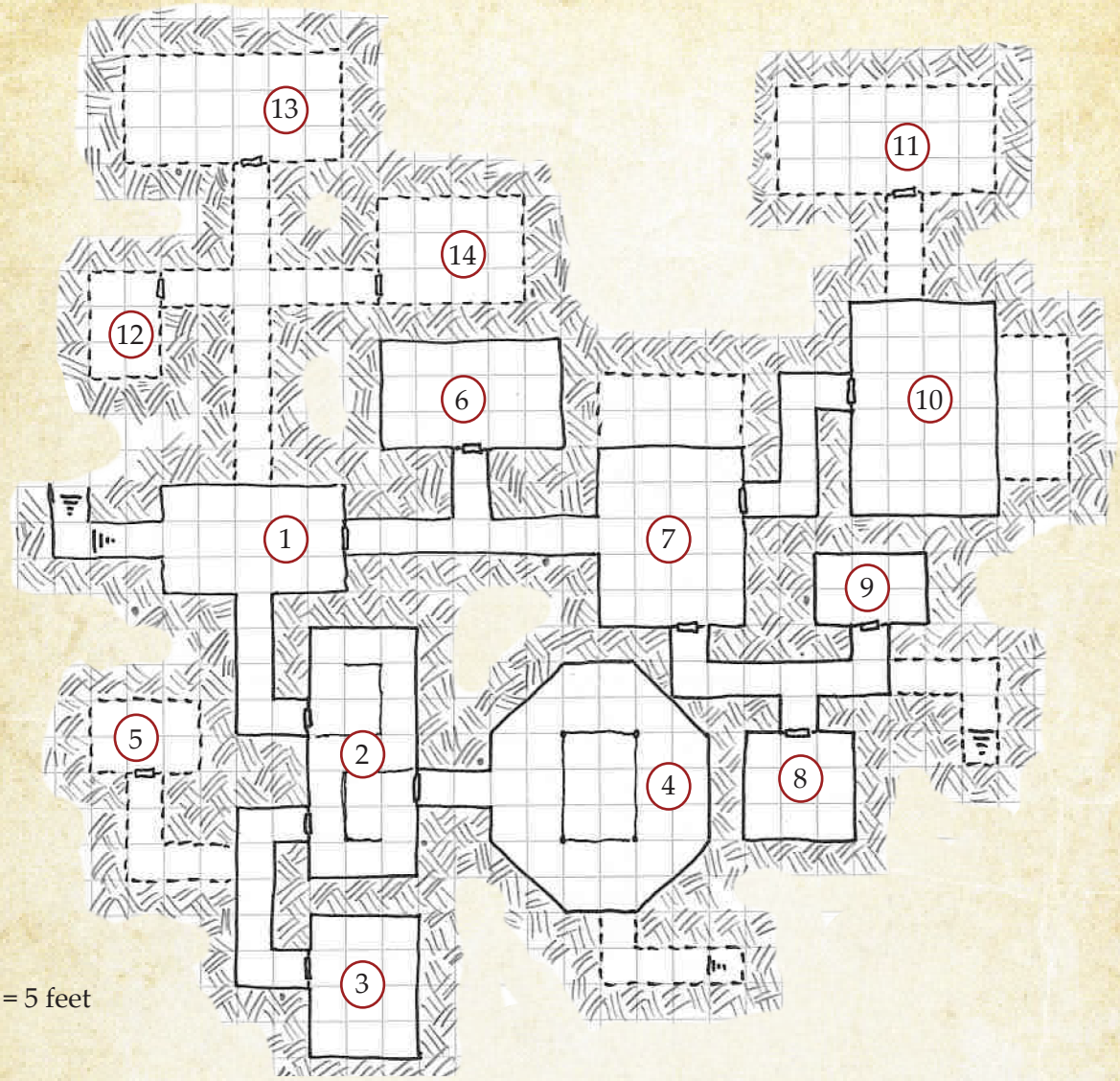
R14. Conference room

In this room Gamling Steelshield used to hold meetings with his captains. A large oak table stands in the middle of the room, with a map of the Dessarin Vale engraved in it. The room is covered in dust and no one has entered it for many years.

Beneath the table is a hidden compartment. With a successful **DC 18 Wisdom (Perception)** check the PC find the compartment. It is locked but the lock is rusted and easy to pick, with a successful **DC 12 Dexterity** check and thieves' tools, the PCs manage to open the lock. Inside the compartment is a steel dagger with onyx encrusted handle. It is still sharp and radiates magic. The dagger is a *Dagger of Venom* and by rubbing the one of the onyxes the blade becomes coated in venom. Also, in the compartment, are three different vials, one yellow, one blue and one red, but the components of the vials have long since evaporated.

R15. Study

The study was simple. It contained a map stand, few books and manuscripts and a luxurious reading sofa. Gamling was not much fan of the written words, though he enjoyed a good story every now and then. Therefore, he used the study as a sanctuary from the busy schedule of running the keep. A couple of windows offer great view of the courtyard and over the Kryptgarden forest. All the books are crumbling, and the pages turn to dust if turned. Hidden in one of the books is a scroll containing the spells *Dispel Magic*, *Flesh to Stone* and *Daylight*. With a successful **DC 12 Wisdom (Perception)** check the PCs spot the scroll.



1 square = 5 feet

Dungeon level 1

D1. Room of the Raven

This antechamber is beautiful. It has mosaic floor, which shows a large raven flying over the keep. With a successful **DC 13 Intelligence (History)** check the PCs see that the mosaics were laid at the same time as when the keep was built.

Two Wraiths (see MM p. 302) and three Skeletons (see MM p. 272) attack anyone entering this room.

There are three doors leading from this room. The north door is only visible to those that have gone through the first four rituals. The doors leading east are locked with an Arcane lock, that only filling the cup in room D3 with blood from a fey creature will unlock.

D2. Glass walls

This room was once a hall where the dwarves used to venerate Dumathoin, the protector of the dwarven dead. Once Kirial discovered this room he defiled the shrine and destroyed everything that reminded of the dwarven religion.

In this room are four shadow blink dogs (Use Shadow Mastiff, see Volo p. 190, add Action: Teleport, recharge 5-6. The shadow blink dog magically teleports, along with any equipment it is wearing or carrying, up to 40 feet to an unoccupied space it can see. Before or after teleporting, the dog can make one bite attack, Medium Fey Creature) that are trained to attack anyone entering the room not attuned to the Rune of Kirial. The warlock-wight feeds the dogs on fey creatures and other sylvan beings.

The room is dark. There are two glass walls, that the dogs can see through but are hard as steel, with a successful **DC 24 Strength (Athletics)** check the PCs manage to break the glass. The dogs will use hit and run tactics, trying to isolate the attacker that appears to be the weakest one.

D3. The Riddle and the Chalice

This room served as a shrine devoted to Dugmaren

Brightmantle. The dwarves of Ravenhold used to create and write manuscripts in this room, though now nothing remains here that is evidence of this room was used.

The walls in this room are carved with bas-reliefs depicting scenes from Flametongue's history along with scenes from Ravenhold. Hidden within the bas-reliefs is a riddle, though with no apparent answer. If the PCs decide to investigate the bas-reliefs, with a successful **DC 15 Intelligence (Investigation)** check they see that every picture includes the dwarven rune for the number six. This refers to the puzzle in room D5.

The walls in this otherwise empty rectangular room are decorated with carvings and bas-reliefs, that show Torhild Flametongue battling trolls from Highmoor, his son Torarinn riding to battle on a mighty boar, ravens flying high over Ravenhold in all its glory and finally a heavily armored dwarf armed with a warhammer standing atop the Ravenhold gatehouse. In one end of the is an ornate desk. On the desk is an iron bird cage and a silver chalice.

With a successful **DC 12 Intelligence (History)** check the PC recognize Gamling Steelshield, Ravenhold's lord in the last bas-relief.

In the birdcage the PCs will find Silastra, a pixie that is almost dead, she is unconscious but breathing. With a successful **DC 10 Wisdom (Medicine)** check the PCs can tell that the Silastra has been almost drained of blood. Inspecting the chalice shows that there are remains of blood in it. With a successful **DC 15 Intelligence (Arcana)** check the PCs will see that the chalice is magical and with the help of divination magic they know that there's a faint abjuration aura emanating from it.

If the chalice is filled with the blood of fey creatures, the chalice's magic will unlock the doors leading east in room D1. If the PCs are not eager to fill the cup with the Silastra's blood, they can use the blood from the shadow blink dogs in room D2. If the PCs heal Silastra or nurse her back to consciousness, she will tell the PCs that Kirial captured her a few tendays ago and has used her blood to fill the cup, but she doesn't know why he does this. With a successful **DC 5 Wisdom (Insight)** check the PCs can tell that she's telling the truth. If the PCs release her, she will thank them from the bottom of her heart and fly away, eager to return to her home in Kryptgarden forest.

D4. The Obsidian Pyramid

A large jet-black pyramid, made out of a single slab of obsidian and carved with golden arcane runes, dominates this room. There's a palpable aura of evil in the room, one that emanates from the pyramid. Val'Xootiz hides its phylactery within the pyramid.

The moment you open the door you sense something terrible, ever hungry and devious. In the middle of the room is a large black pyramid, laid with golden arcane runes. Three translucent drow warriors float around it, their eyes vacant and cold. As they notice you, they draw their weapons and move to attack.

The drow ghost warriors are Specters (see MM p. 279). These are followers of Val'Xootiz, the Alhoon, and placed here to protect his phylactery.

With a successful **DC 15 Intelligence (Arcana)** check the PCs can see that the runes are to deter anyone from trying to dispel the magic that are cast on the pyramid. With a *Detect Magic* spell the PC can feel that there's a magical aura surrounding it, one emanating from an low level abjuration spell. Using *Identify* reveals that this spell is *Arcane Lock*.

Val'Xootiz uses an *Arcane Lock* spell to lock the only opening to the pyramid, which is less than inch wide on the eastern side. Val'Xootiz uses *Gaseous Form* to enter the small room within, that hides its phylactery, which is a golden egg, laid with diamonds and gemstones.

If the PCs manage to find a way to enter the chamber, they will find the phylactery standing on a pedestal and the room is otherwise empty. The pedestal is trapped. With a successful **DC 18 Wisdom (Perception)** check the PCs spot the magical trap. The trap can be disabled using *Dispel Magic* or the magical keyword, Uratha-Malika, known only to Val'Xootiz. If the trap is not disabled, it casts Flesh to Stone on whoever removes the phylactery from the pedestal, with a successful **DC 18 Constitution** save the PCs manage to withstand the spell effect.

If the PCs are attuned to the Rune of Kirial they will find a doorway in the south end of the room. There they will see a staircase leading down to dungeon level 2.

D5. Tomb of Arica Brittlestone

The entrance to the tomb is only visible to those that have completed the fourth ritual.

The air is still, and a deep sense of sorrow fills your heart as you enter the small tomb. The sarcophagus

is made of white marble with grey veins, inlaid with silver and gold. It is rune-encrusted and decorated with many sigils and protective holy symbols. The walls have colorful frescos, showing a regal dwarven woman, with grey eyes and dark hair. The fresco above the sarcophagus shows her fighting a large green dragon. On either side of the sarcophagus stand iron chests, the one on the right is smaller than the one on the left.

With a successful **DC 20 Intelligence (History)** check the PCs recognize Arica Brittlestone and know that she was once the chamberlain in Ravenhold but was killed battling a green dragon.

The sarcophagus' lid is very heavy and hard to move. With a successful **DC 23 Strength (Athletics)** check the PCs manage to move the lid. Inside are the mummified remains of Arica Brittlestone.

The right chest is not locked and has been emptied by Kirial's minions, since the warlock-wight doesn't want to enter the tomb. Now the small chest only contains a small leather bag containing nine small stones of the same size, each marked with a numeric rune, which stand for the numbers 1-9.

The left chest is locked and using the small stones found in the other chest can open the lock. If the PCs try to pry the chest open, with a successful **DC 25 Strength (Athletics)** check the PCs manage to open it. The lock however has nine similarly sized holes, 3x3, one for each stone. The PCs need to place a stone in each hole and make sure that the sum of each line, both horizontal and vertical, is 15.

If they have investigated room D3 they might have a lead, though the lead itself is a riddle. The lead was the number 6, which is the digit sum of 15.

If the PCs manage to open the large iron chest, they will find the rest of the items that were put in Brittlestone's tomb. In the chest are *Warhammer +1* and *Bronze dragon scale mail*.

D6. Ritual Chamber

Val'Xootiz set up the ritual chamber to power his ritual. He uses dark magic to syphon the life spirit of the unicorn and harnesses it. The alhoon uses it to power a special form of Antipathy, in which Val'Xootiz targets Old Gnawbone and repels the dragon from entering Deeping Cave, where the dragon's lair is.

The unicorn, Aileeke, was captured a few weeks ago and has been visited regularly by Val'Xootiz, where he performs the ritual to keep the dragon at bay. Aileeke has been petrified and is unable to move or use any of its magical abilities.

A large arcane symbol has been etched into the floor, which spouts small blue lightnings every now and then. In the middle of the symbol stands a motionless, but marvelous and beautiful unicorn.

With a successful **DC 15 Intelligence (Arcana)** check the PCs see that symbol is heavily enchanted.

With a successful **DC 15 Wisdom (Medicine)** check the PCs can tell that the unicorn has been petrified and powerful spells are needed to help it.

If the PCs manage to release it from the enchantment it will thank the PCs. It will urge them to stop both Kirial and Val'Xootiz and tell them that the Alhoon has imprisoned other unicorns as well, though Aileeke doesn't know where. Aileeke doesn't know why Val'Xootiz imprisoned her but she knows however that the alhoon has taken over Old Gnawbones' lair.

If the PCs ask Aileeke about Lia, the name doesn't ring any bells for the unicorn. If the PCs describe the elven ranger, Aileeke will suspect that it might be Old Gnawbone due to the ranger's green eyes, though she doesn't mention it. With a successful **DC 18 Wisdom (Insight)** check the PCs get the feeling that the unicorn is withholding some information. Aileeke isn't too keen of sharing her suspicions, with a successful **DC 20 Charisma (Persuasion)** check the PCs manage to convince Aileeke to speak up about her concerns.

Alieeke can and will offer to heal any of the PCs, as a token of her gratitude. If the PCs have rescued Yiriala, Aileeke can also heal her.

D7. Ruined Temple of Moradin

This room used to be a temple devoted the dwarven deity Moradin and was one of the most spectacular room in the keep. The walls were decorated with tapestries, the holy symbol of Moradin was inlaid with gold in the floor and at the center of the room stood a large rune-encrusted anvil. A PC that reads Dwarvish can read the runes, which say: "Honor the Soulforger in all your tasks. Wisdom is derived from life and tempered with experience. Honor your clan leaders as you honor the Dwarffather." With a successful **DC 10 Intelligence (Religion)** check the PCs know that this is the heart of Moradin's dogma.

This was once a magnificent hall devoted to worship. Almost in the middle of the room is a large rune-encrusted anvil and the ruins of gold- and silver-threaded tapestries hang from the walls. In the floor the holy symbol of Moradin is etched and it is evident that it once was laid with gold. The room is silent, as if in mourning of bygone times.

The room is empty save for the anvil. The anvil itself is blessed by Moradin and as such radiates strong Conjuration magic. If an evil creature touches the anvil an Earth Elemental (see MM p. 124) is summoned into the room, that attacks whomever touched the anvil. If a good aligned dwarf touches the anvil, that person will feel a sense of peace, wisdom and Moradin's strength flow through him or her. That dwarf will feel a stronger bond to Ravenhold and the desire to cleanse the old keep of the dark aura that surrounds it. Award that person with Inspiration.

Kirial has touched the anvil once and is not eager to make that mistake again. The undead of the place stay clear of the temple, since it still has some of the hallowedness it once had. Neither the anvil nor the holy symbol in the floor are completely in the middle of the room. Both seem a bit more in the northern end, and the holy symbol is not quite complete, as if a part of it has fallen under the wall.

If the PCs have completed the third ritual the temple is larger. The space that is partly within the Shadowfell is more morbid, the tapestries are still intact but showing dwarves with deep sadness in their eyes, carrying a chest into a mausoleum. If the PCs see the temple having complete the ritual, then they notice that the symbol etched into the floor and anvil are in the middle of the room.

D8. High Priests' room

This room once served the high priests of Moradin, though it has fallen into ruins. Kirial has long since stripped it of any valuables.

> What is left of this room indicates that it was the living quarters of someone of importance. The bed was once soft and the desk ornate and carved. Beside the desk was a bookcase, but someone has already plundered what valuables were hidden here.

With a successful **DC 15 Intelligence (Investigate)** check the PCs find that the holy symbol of Moradin is etched into a bed post. Rummaging through the rest of the books, the PCs discover that the few books that are still intact bear titles such as Serving the Dwarffather, Soulforger - Saviour of dwarvenkind and Life in Moradin. With a successful **DC 15 Intelligence (Religion)** check the PCs know that these are books that clerics of Moradin read while they are acolytes.

In the hallway between room D8 and D9 is another hallway, leading to stairs that go down to dungeon level 2. The hallway is only visible to those that have the Rune of Kirial.

D9. Ruined room

This room is in complete ruins but was once the living quarters for the acolytes. The floor is littered with ruined desks, bunkers and cabinets and the air is dank with the smell of mildew. There's nothing of interest in this room.

D10. Scales of Darkness

What once served as a room for all manner of dwarven craftsmen is now a mere shadow of it former self. There are few desk and stations where toymakers, jewelers, carpenters and other craftsmen honed their craft for the glory of Moradin and the Flametongue clan.

One of these craftsmen, a dwarven wizard named Everwind Ironhandle and an expert clay maker, had a Clay Golem (see MM p. 167), which was a helping hand to him when he was crafting his items. He named his golem Leir and the golem is still there, waiting for Ironhandle to return.

> Once this hall echoed with the sound of different tools and the many craftsmen at work. Dust covers most of the workbenches and tables, and the smell of dust is strong. The vaulted ceiling was once painted, though left are mere traces of the artwork that once decorated the ceiling. In the far end is a large set of bronze scales. As you enter the room, there's a movement. A statue, it seems, shaped like a dwarven male, steps forward. "Master?" it says, its voice hollow.

The golem is non-threatening. Ironhandle instructed it to wait for him, but the wizard never returned. Leir waits patiently for the return of its master. Though Leir has a bit higher intelligence than normal Clay Golems (it has Int 4) and can speak though it only knows four words (Yes, No, Master, Leir), it only obeys Ironhandle. The golem will not leave the room unless told to do so by Ironhandle.

Kirial has already tried to convince the golem to guard the Scales of Darkness, with no luck. He decided to leave the golem alone, hoping that any intruders might mistake the golem for one of his creations and attack it.

If the PCs decide to investigate the scales, they see a single black feather of a roc in one container, but the other one empty. The scales are large enough for a medium sized humanoid to step onto the contained. If a PC steps on the container and weighs more

than the feather, nothing happens. However, if the PC weighs less than the feather, that has solved the fourth ritual. For a PC to be lighter than the feather any use of spells like *Feather fall*, *Levitate* etc. are appropriate. Reward clever thinking.

If the PCs have solved the third ritual, they will see that the hall is a bit larger and hidden in shadows are a few more desks, one where the skeletal remains of a dwarven toymaker, a small rotten wooden doll in its hands. Beneath his desk, hidden in dust, are brass glasses, with lenses that are *Eyes of Minute Seeing*. With a successful **DC 15 Wisdom (Perception)** check the PCs spot the glasses.

Once the PCs have gone through the fourth ritual, they will see a hallway in the northern end of the hall, leading to D11.

D11. Craftsmen's quarters

The craftsmen who lived and worked in Ravenhold had their own quarters. Very often these were travelling craftsmen who came to Ravenhold to work on special projects, like building the keep or weaving the tapestries that once adorned the walls of the keep.

There are a few bunkers in this room, now mostly in ruins and the wood rotten. By each bunker is a chest, which all have been pried open or unlocked. There's a hidden compartment in one of these, by the bunker in the far eastern corner. With a successful **DC 18 Intelligence (Investigation)** check the PCs find the compartment. With a successful **DC 15 Dexterity** check and thieves tools the PCs manage to unlock the compartment. Within it is a signet ring, bearing the family crest of the Flametongue family. The ring is magical, and functions as *Ring of Protection*.

On the western wall is a glass cabinet, where once were displayed many fine pieces of craftsmanship. The craftsmen who came to Ravenhold got to leave one item of their own making in the cabinet, for other craftsmen to admire. Most of the stands are empty now, but the names on the plaques are still readable. Names such as Breg Shorthandle, Ulfr Axebreaker, Iriana Ivanson and Valgerdur Ironclaw. With a successful **DC 25 Intelligence (History)** check the PCs recognize these fine dwarven craftsmen. Shorthandle took part in building the Stone Bridge in Dessarin Vale. Axebreaker was once the finest sword maker along the Sword Coast. Ivanson was a master tapestry maker and Ironclaw was a gem cutter, who some claim to have cut the Gem of Dumathoin (see D16). The glass cabinet has been emptied by robbers and later Kirial.

D12. Tomb of Gamling Steelshield

The tomb of Gamling Steelshield is nowhere as rich or beautiful as the tomb of Arica Brittlestone. This tomb reflects the dwarf entombed in it, it is spartan, simple and modest. In the far end stands a non-descript sarcophagus, devoid of any bas-reliefs, save for the Steelshield emblem on top of it.

At the other end of this otherwise empty room is a lone sarcophagus. It is square and made from stone. On top of the lid is an emblem, etched into the stone.

With a successful **DC 18 Intelligence (History)** check the PCs recognize the emblem, if they haven't already.

The sarcophagus is made of stone. With a successful **DC 15 Strength (Athletics)** check PCs manage to push the lid of the chest, revealing only dust and a single empty scabbard for a shortsword.

Steelshield's sword was taken by Kirial, who stashed it away in his chamber.

D13. The Shadowsworn

What once served as small chapel dedicated to the many smaller dwarven deities has now been ruined and unhallowed. Kirial has claimed this room and thrown out or destroyed anything that reminded him of what this room was once used for. At the far end is an obsidian altar, upon which stands a brass bowl, full of black water. The bowl is magical and if the PCs put their hand into the water, the Rune of Kirial will appear on the hand. However, there are 2 black flameskulls (see MM p. 134), called The Shadowsvorn, guarding the room and they will allow none to enter or use the bowl, that aren't with Kirial. If the PCs are wearing the *Robe of Eyes* and holding the *Wand of Paralyzis*, items that were once in Kirial's possession, the flameskulls will not attack.

> The vaulted ceiling of this room and the many small alcoves seem to imply that this room was once some sort of chapel. Now it is desecrated and only a perverted resemblance of what it once was. In the far end of the room is a raised dais, upon which an obsidian altar stands. On the altar are a brass bowl and two dark skulls, that sprout black flames as you enter, and float into the air.

If the PCs are not wearing the items that Garmund gave them the flameskulls attack and fight to the death. With a successful **DC 15 Intelligence (Arcana)** check the PCs understand that the bowl is magical. If a PC puts their hand into the bowl the water is freezing cold. The Rune of Kirial appears on the hand. If each

PC attunes to their runes, they have completed the fifth and final ritual and are now completely in the Shadowfell. Now they can see the stairs that lead down to level 2.

D14. The Whispering Hall

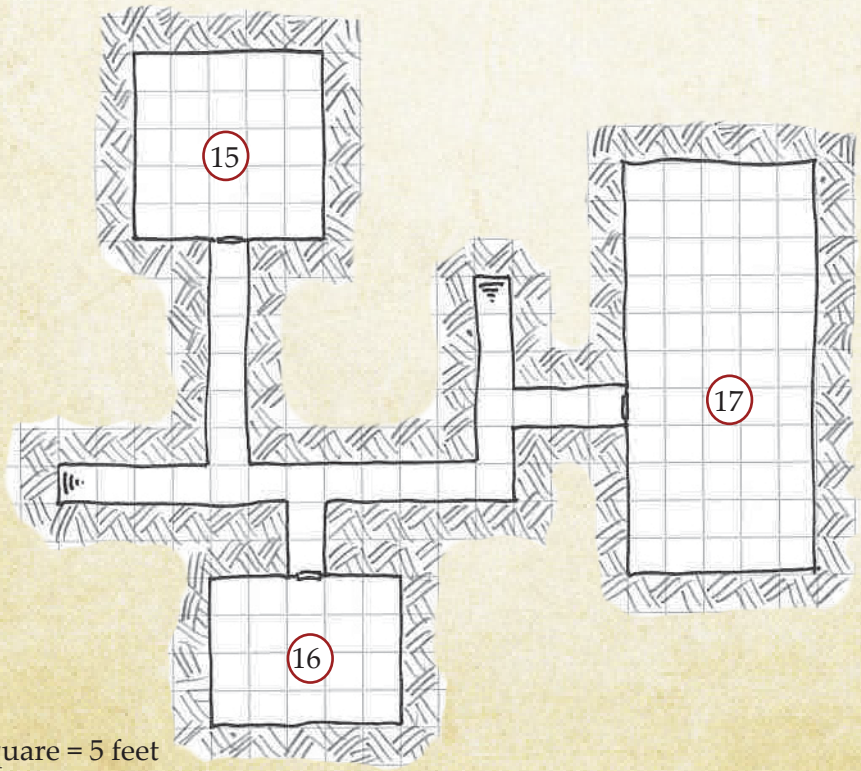
The Whispering Hall was initially a place where the dwarves of Ravenhold venerated their ancestors and lost loved ones. With a successful **DC 15 Intelligence (History)** check the PCs recognize the room for what it once was. The walls are lined with small alcoves where the dwarves placed small icons and other memorophilia. The caretaker, Jervenor Silvermane, took his responsibilities beyond the grave and is still in the hall, as ghost (see MM p. 147). He floats greets the PCs as they enter the room and puts a finger to his lips. As long as the PCs do not disturb the alcoves in any way Jervenor will leave the PCs alone. If they take anything from the alcoves he will attack. If the PCs try to communicate with Jervenor he will only speak in dwarvish. He will tell the PCs that his task is to take care of the Whispering Hall, though few dwarves have visited it in recent years. If the PCs tell him that Gamling has passed away, as well as Torhild Flametongue, he will refuse to believe it. With a successful **DC 10 Wisdom (Insight)** check the PCs know that trying to convince the undead dwarf otherwise will be at best nigh impossible.

The alcoves contain a few treasures. One alcove has a small brooch, which is a *Brooch of Shielding*. Another alcove holds an onyx statue of a dog, which is a *figurine of wondrous power*. Yet another alcove has a jade stone which is worth 150 gps. With a successful *DC 15 Wisdom (Perception)* check the PCs spot these items.

Dungeon level 2

The lower level of the dungeon was made by Kirial and Val'Xootiz. It is in fact a part of the Shadowfell, and reachable only by attuning to the Rune of Kirial and finding either entrance in the dungeon below Ravenhold. This is Kirial's lair and molded mostly by his will. While in his lair Kirial can use his legendary actions.

Kirial spends most of his time in the rooms on this level. Once the PCs enter, he will turn to face them, if the PCs take no precautions of keeping their presence hidden or using stealth. Only 20 rounds after the PCs enter the level Kirial, should the PCs not have found the warlock-wight, will find them and attack furiously. If Kirial loses more than 75% of his hit points Kirial will try to flee and escape into Kryptgarden Forest, seeking Deeping Cave.



1 square = 5 feet

D15. Library

Kirial's library is not large but has a few rare and hard to find spellbooks. It has a desk and a bookcase. In it are a few books and manuscripts where Necromancy and dark magic is the main topic. Some of the books Kirial found in the ruins of Sakkors in Sembia, others he found in Netherese ruins in Anauroch. The rest he purchased or stole from other wizards, warlocks and sorcerers. Judging by his collection he seems very interested in Shadow magic.

A large desk dominates the center of the room. Behind it is a bookcase made of dark wood, it holds many old and dusty tomes, many of which are bound in dark leather with metal bindings. The desk is simple and a heavy antler candle holder with a black candle. The wax has dripped over the antler.

There are three drawers in the desk, all of which are locked. With a successful **DC 15 Dexterity** check and thieves tools the locks can be picked. There is a poison needle trap (see DMG p. 120) in the middle drawer. The left drawer contains a small vial, which is a *Potion of Invisibility*. The middle drawer holds papers, notes and letters that Kirial owns. Most of these are his personal notes about Shadow magic. One paper has notes on Val'Xootiz, saying following: Val'Xootiz needs more fey creatures for his ritual, keeping the dragon at bay drains the alhoon's power. The dragon referred to is the ancient green dragon Claugiyliamater or Old Gnawbone that made her lair in the Deeping Cave, deep in Kryptgarden Forest. The right drawer has a scroll holding the spells Darkness, Teleport and Gaseous form.

If the PCs manage to surprise Kirial, the warlock-wight is in this room, studying a heavy tome, bound in black velvet. The tome is called Scotomancy and is believed to have been originally penned by the Netherese arch-mage Shade.

D16. Kirial's Quarters

The Warlock-Wight's quarters are not luxurious, since the undead doesn't need to sleep or eat. However, Kirial has acquired many art pieces and treasures, some of which were drawn from Ravenhold.

A heavy rotten smell fills the air in this room. An old chair is in one corner and a small table beside it on which a golden gem-encrusted chalice stands. Two beautiful tapestries hang on the walls. Beside the doorway is a large wooden chest.

Hidden in the room is an Intellect Devourer (see MM p. 191). It will stay hidden, being intelligent enough to know when it is overmatched. If discovered, it will fight to the death.

There are two tapestries that are still more or less intact, one displaying Ravenhold under a new moon, where Selune is all but invisible. The other one shows Torhild Flametongue battling a troll. Both are intricately woven by master weavers, with gold and silver threads. With a successful **DC 15 Intelligence** check the PCs suspect they could earn about 300 gps by selling these, even more if sold to dwarves.

With a successful **DC 10 Intelligence** check the PCs know that they can sell the golden chalice for at least 500 gps.

The chest is locked. With a successful **DC 18 Dexterity** check and thieves tools the PCs manage to open it. Kirial also has a key to the lock. The chest contains 2 leather pouches, one containing 3 diamond each worth 100 gps, the other one contains 5 blood stones, each worth 50 gps. Also, in the chest are a *Leather Armor +1*, *Periapt of Mind Shielding* (as Ring of Mind Shielding, see DMG p. 191), a *Short Sword +1* (taken from Steelshield's tomb) and vial containing scorpion poison (see DMG p. 257).

D17. Temple of Shar

Kirial is a devout follower of the goddess Shar. The Warlock-Wight built a small temple to honor the goddess and it is here he brought Yiriala, Garmund's wife. He has been torturing her and is planning on sacrificing her soon.

This room is dark. Somewhere you can hear labored, shallow breathing. The air smells of some forlorn incense and blood. Then a voice, a mere hoarse whisper, pleads: "Kill me please, Kirial, just get it over with."

The temple is covered in a magical darkness. If the PCs dispel the darkness, they can see a black altar in the far end. Beside the altar is a crux decussata, where Yiriala is bound. She is almost naked, only wearing loin cloth and her skin has been cut in many places. Her eyes have been cut out, and blood stains her face. With a successful **DC 10 Wisdom (Medicine)** check the PCs know that Yiriala needs more powerful form of healing, if she is ever to see again.

If the PCs set her free and help her, she is at first very alarmed and afraid that their help is some sort of perverted play of Kirial, toying with her only to finally break her spirit. With a successful DC 10

Wisdom (Insight) check the PCs feel that Yiriala has suffered a trauma and will take weeks to recover from it. With a successful **DC 15 Charisma (Persuasion)** check the PCs convince Yiriala that they are there to help her, sent by her husband Garmund.

If the PCs inspect the altar, they will discover that it is covered with blood. Yiriala's eyes are in an obsidian cup on the altar. A sacrificial dagger and a whip rest beside the altar, neither are magical.

Conclusion

If the PCs manage to free Yiriala she is eager to return to Garmund and Olaf, who are still in Red Larch. The travel there is uneventful but in Red Larch the PCs can, after meeting Garmund, Olaf and Anabel, also meet Lia, who is in The Swinging Sword and eager to hear their story. When Yiriala has recovered she will inform the PCs that she discovered that Kirial was her half-brother, that they had the same father. She will also tell the PCs, if they didn't figure it out for themselves, that Val'Xootiz is syphoning the life energies of unicorns to place an enchantment on the forest. She overheard the alhoon and Kirial speak one night and knows that the unicorn in Ravenhold is not the only unicorn being tortured by the undead.

If Kirial manages to escape he will seek out Val'Xootiz and warn the alhoon about the PCs. Should the PCs manage to free Alieeke, the unicorn, they have not only dealt Val'Xootiz a serious blow and weakened the undead's defenses against Old Gnawbone, but also gained a valuable ally in Kryptgarden Forest.

Appendix A: New Monsters

Warlock Wight

Medium undead, neutral evil

Armor Class 14 (Studded Leather)

Hit Points 45 (8d8 + 18)

Speed 30 ft.

STR	DEX	CON	INT	WIS	CHA
15 (+2)	14 (+2)	16 (+3)	10 (+0)	13 (+1)	17 (+3)

Skills Arcana +2, Perception +3, Stealth +4

Damage Resistances Necrotic; Bludgeoning, Piercing, and Slashing from Nonmagical Attacks that aren't Silvered

Damage Immunities Poison

Condition Immunities Exhaustion, Poisoned

Senses Darkvision 60 ft., Passive Perception 13

Languages The languages it knew in life

Challenge 8 (3,900 XP)

Innate Spellcasting. The warlock wight's innate spellcasting ability Charisma (spell save DC 13). It can innately cast the following spells, requiring no verbal or material components.

At will: *detect magic, disguise self, mage armor*

Spellcasting. The warlock wight is a 6th level spellcaster. Its spellcasting ability is Charisma (spell save DC 13, +5 to hit with a spell attack). The warlock has 2 3rd level spells slots and knows the following spells:

Cantrips: *chill touch, poison spray, eldritch blast*
1st level: *arms of Hadar, hex, witch bolt*
2nd level: *misty step, ray of enfeeblement*
3rd level: *hunger of hadar, vampiric touch*

Sunlight Sensitivity. While in sunlight, the wight has disadvantage on attack rolls, as well as on Wisdom (Perception) checks that rely on sight.

Actions

Multiattack. The warlock wight makes two longsword attacks or two longbow attacks. It can use its Life Drain in place of one longsword attack.

Necrotic Eldritch Blast. *Ranged Spell Attack:* +5 to hit, reach 50 ft., one creature. Hit: 7 (1d10+3) necrotic damage. The target must succeed on a DC 13 Constitution saving throw or be stunned for 1 round.

Life Drain. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one creature. *Hit:* 5 (1d6 + 2) necrotic damage. The target must succeed on a DC 13 Constitution saving throw or its hit point maximum is reduced by an amount equal to the damage taken. This reduction lasts until the target finishes a long rest. The target dies if this effect reduces its hit point maximum to 0.

A humanoid slain by this attack rises 24 hours later as a zombie under the wight's control, unless the humanoid is restored to life or its body is destroyed. The wight can have no more than twelve zombies under its control at one time.

Longsword. *Melee Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, reach 5 ft., one target. *Hit:* 6 (1d8 + 2) slashing damage, or 7 (1d10 + 2) slashing damage if used with two hands.

Longbow. *Ranged Weapon Attack:* +4 to hit, range 150/600 ft., one target. *Hit:* 6 (1d8 + 2) piercing damage.

Legendary Actions

The warlock-wight can take 3 legendary action, choosing from the options below. Only one legendary action option can be used at a time and only at the end of another creature's turn. The warlock-wight regains spent legendary actions at the start of its turn.

Misty Step (costs 2 actions). The Warlock-Wight uses Misty Step.

Riposte blast. If an attack misses the Warlock-Wight it can riposte with a Necrotic Eldritch Blast.

Detect. The Warlock-Wight makes a Wisdom (Perception) check.